Accessing and using digital course resources

Practical guide for students | D14-ST

Digital access includes being able to open, understand and use the resources required for your course. Test important tools early so that technical or language difficulties can be addressed before a deadline.

1. Find the official starting point

Use the course site or link provided by your institution. Locate weekly materials, assessment instructions, announcements and support contacts. Ask your teacher if you cannot identify the current version.

2. Test access early

Check that your account works and that required files open on your device. Test essential audio, video and software. Tell your teacher if device, connection or account limitations prevent access.

3. Practise unfamiliar steps

Try low-stakes activities before an assessed task, where available. Check terms such as upload, attach and submit. Ask for a demonstration if the written instructions are insufficient.

4. Choose tools that support understanding

Use available captions, transcripts, zoom or text-to-speech when helpful. Check unclear technical terms against course materials. For translation or AI tools, follow course rules and verify the meaning of outputs.

5. Check that your work is saved or submitted

Keep an organised copy of your work. After an upload, check the file and any confirmation provided by the system. Saving a draft may be different from submitting it.

6. Report problems clearly

Give the resource name, time, device and error message, and explain what you have tried. Use the official support route. If a deadline is affected, contact your teacher promptly and follow the local procedure.

7. Example

A worksheet opens on your phone but the embedded spreadsheet does not. You report the file name and the error before the task is due, and ask whether a campus computer or accessible alternative is available. You check that the agreed option lets you complete the same learning task.

8. Quick checklist

☐ I can access the required resources.

☐ I have practised unfamiliar steps.

☐ I know the course rules for digital tools.

☐ I know how to report a problem.

9. When to seek further support

Contact IT support for account or software problems, your teacher for task requirements, and relevant access or accessibility services for persistent barriers. Reporting a problem does not automatically extend a deadline; check the official process.

10.Supporting sources

SUNY Online. (n.d.). OSCQR Standard 8. Open resource

Educator guidance supports making technical requirements, access instructions and help-desk routes explicit. Student troubleshooting steps are adaptations.

RMIT University. (n.d.). Mastering online class participation. Learning Lab. Open resource

Supports becoming familiar with the learning platform and locating content, announcements, assessment and feedback. Platform-specific examples are illustrative.